

Dhāraṇī That Pacifies the Disease of Smallpox

Toh 627 · Derge Kangyur

འབམྲ་བཟུ་ནིད་ཞིབར་བདྱེ་པའ་གི་ཟདུས།

Toh 627 in the Kangyur is a collection of dhāraṇī texts — short ritual incantation scriptures — dealing with protection, healing, and the warding off of various harms. The text opens with a dhāraṇī invoking Mañjuśrī Kumāra and all the tathāgatas for the pacification of smallpox, followed immediately by a second dhāraṇī known in Sanskrit as something close to "That Which Does Not Steal Away Radiance" and in Tibetan as རྒྱལ་ལོ་མེད་པའི་མཁའ་འགྲུབ་ཀྱི་མཁའ་འཁོར་ལྷ་མོ།, associated with lapis-lazuli light and accompanied by instructions for ritual preparation using costus root, white mustard, and fat. These texts belong to the broader category of dhāraṇī and ritual literature preserved in the Kangyur, reflecting the tradition of scriptures focused on practical protective and therapeutic applications of sacred speech. As a collection of such brief but distinct dhāraṇī, each with its own dedicatory homage and specific purpose, Toh 627 represents the kind of applied, mantra-centered Buddhist literature intended to be recited or performed for the benefit of beings suffering from illness and misfortune.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

He bhagavān Mañjuśrī kumāra, sarva tathāgata bala vidhijña, sarva
tathāgatānām nāgaiḥ stisṭha sarva sattvānām svāhā.

This concludes the dhāraṇī that pacifies the disease of smallpox.

Homage to the lapis-lazuli light, known as "That Which Does Not Steal Away Radiance."

Tadyathā: oṃ mama rakṣa, sāgare mahāsāgare, puru ce puru curu, samane
me, deva be hulu hulu svāhā.

One takes costus root and white mustard, mixes them with black bhisuna, and kneads them into a ball. One then makes a round drop of fat on the back of a door and recites the mantra seven times. What arises...

Translator's Notes

- The passage contains two distinct dhāraṇī texts. The first is a complete dhāraṇī for pacifying smallpox invoking Mañjuśrī. The second, titled "That Which Does Not Steal Away Radiance," is associated with the lapis-lazuli light, likely a Vaiḍūrya deity or Bhaiṣajyaguru context, and its ritual instructions are cut off mid-sentence at "what arises," indicating the passage is incomplete. The Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan

phonetic transcription without emendation, as the precise Sanskrit Vorlage cannot be reconstructed with certainty in all details. The term rendered "bhisuna" for भिसुना is a plant ingredient of uncertain precise identification; "black bhisuna" is the most literal rendering available. The phrase भिसुनाद्विषमोक्षं is literally "having made a drop of fat on the back," most naturally understood as applying a ritual smear or pellet of fat on the back of a door panel.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.